

Hyster Operator Safety & Operations Manual

1. Introduction to Safe Operation

Operating a Hyster forklift requires more than just driving skills; it requires a commitment to safety and a deep understanding of the machine's physics.

Operator Qualifications: Only trained and authorized personnel shall operate a lift truck.

Safety First: Always wear your seatbelt. In the event of a tip-over, do not jump; stay in the seat, grip the wheel firmly, and lean away from the point of impact.

2. Pre-Operational Inspection Checklist

Perform these checks at the start of every shift. If any issues are found, tag the machine "Out of Service."

Visual Checks:

Tires: Check for chunks, flat spots, or embedded debris.

Forks/Chains: Look for cracks, bends, or excessive wear.

Fluids: Inspect for leaks (hydraulic fluid, fuel, coolant).

Mast: Check for damaged rollers or loose bolts.

Operational Checks:

Brakes: Ensure the service and parking brakes hold firmly.

Steering: Check for smooth movement without excessive play.

Controls: Test lift, tilt, and side-shift functions.

Warning Devices: Test the horn, lights, and back-up alarm.

3. Stability Fundamentals

The stability of a forklift is based on the Stability Triangle. The center of gravity must stay within this triangle (formed by the front tires and the center of the rear axle).

The Load Center: Always keep the load against the carriage.

The Danger Zone: Raising a load shifts the center of gravity forward. Never turn with a raised load.

Speed: High speeds and sharp turns are the primary causes of tip-overs.

4. Safe Handling of Loads

Capacity: Never exceed the maximum lifting capacity listed on the Data Plate.

Picking up a Load: Square up to the load, spread forks as wide as possible for stability, and drive under the pallet until it touches the carriage.

Traveling: * Keep forks 10–15 cm off the ground while moving.

Always tilt the mast back slightly to secure the load.

If a load blocks your forward view, drive in reverse.

5. Ramp and Incline Procedures

Loaded: Always drive with the load pointed upgrade (forward going up, reverse going down).

Unloaded: Always drive with the forks pointed downgrade.

Never Turn: Never attempt to turn on a ramp or incline.

6. Dangerous Goods & Specialized Protocols

When moving hazardous materials:

Documentation: Ensure you have the proper manifest or Tremcard.

Stability: Move slower than usual; liquids in containers can “slosh,” shifting the center of gravity unexpectedly.

Static: Ensure the truck is properly grounded if required for flammable materials.

7. Parking and Shutdown

Bring the truck to a complete stop.

Lower the forks until they are flat on the floor.

Tilt the mast forward slightly.

Apply the parking brake.

Turn off the engine/power and remove the key.

Disclaimer: This manual is a guide for educational purposes. Always refer to the specific Hyster model-specific manufacturer manual and local OHS (Occupational Health and Safety) regulations for compliance